

Twelve-Month Dossier I — Governance, Law, Economy and Labour

Chapter F10.3 — August 2025 to 1 August 2026, Weighted to What This Examination Asks



Module	Foundation Layer — Module 10 — Integrated Current Affairs
Chapter	Chapter F10.3
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IMPORTANT · THE WINDOW, THE CUT-OFF, AND WHAT THAT MEANS

This chapter and F10.4 together are the **exhaustive twelve-month dossier**: events from **August 2025 to the cut-off of 1 August 2026**. Every item carries a source link.

Three conventions govern the whole dossier, and they matter more than any single fact in it.

1 The cut-off is applied strictly. Where an event straddles 1 August 2026 it is included and the straddle is **stated** — the Commonwealth Games closed on 2 August 2026, one day outside, and F10.4 §5 says so rather than quietly rounding. Where an item falls days *before* the window opens it is marked as a preceding anchor, as NISAR's launch of 30 July 2025 is in F10.4 §3.

2 Weighting follows F10.1 §1.2, not the news cycle. An EPFO paper's eight current affairs marks are not distributed like a general knowledge quiz. **§1 — labour, social security and the EPFO — is the longest section in the dossier and should be read first and twice.** Sport, awards and obituaries are compact by deliberate decision, and F10.4 §5 records why.

3 The dossier does not replace F10.1's system; it starts it. F10.1 §3 prescribes a monthly register the candidate keeps himself. This chapter supplies the **twelve months already elapsed**, so that the register begins with a full year behind it rather than from zero. **From today, you maintain it.** F10.1 §4's twelve-item sweep still applies to every figure here.

HIGH YIELD · FOUR ITEMS IN THIS CHAPTER CHANGE WHAT THE LAW IS

Most current affairs adds facts. **Four items in the past twelve months have replaced statutes**, and each makes a previously correct answer wrong. They are the single most likely source of a 2026 current affairs question.

Change	From	To	Effective
Rural employment guarantee	MGNREGA, 2005 — 100 days	VB-G RAM G Act, 2025 — 125 days	1 July 2026
Insurance FDI	74%	100%	5 Feb 2026
Income tax	Income-tax Act, 1961	Income-tax Act, 2025	1 April 2026
Labour law	29 separate central Acts	Four labour codes	21 Nov 2025

This manual has been corrected for all four. F4.4 §2.3 now reads 125 days; F7.1 now reads 100%; F4.3 §3.3 and F10.2 §1 carry the other two. If your own notes predate late 2025, **they do not.**

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0. How This Chapter Works

STUDY SESSION · CHAPTER F10.3

1. **Session 1** — Labour, social security and the EPFO (§1) ★★★★★
2. **Session 2** — Law and legislation (§2) ★★★★★
3. **Session 3** — Polity, elections and constitutional offices (§3) ★★★★★★
4. **Session 4** — Economy and public finance (§4) ★★★★★
5. **Session 5** — Schemes launched or extended (§5) ★★★★★★

Then **40 graded questions in §6**. Budget **two evenings**, and give §1 the larger share of the first.

How to use it with F10.2. F10.2 is the **standing dossier** — the position as it stands, organised by subject. F10.3 and F10.4 are the **twelve-month record** — what changed, when, and on whose authority. Where the two overlap, F10.2 gives the current state and this chapter gives the date and the instrument. Neither is redundant: an examiner may ask *what the position is* or *when it changed*.

1. Session 1 — Labour, Social Security and the EPFO ★★★★★

Read this section twice. It is the part of the dossier closest to the post applied for, and the part where a general current affairs compilation will help you least.

1.1 The labour codes — from commencement to full operation

HIGH YIELD · THE SEQUENCE, WHICH IS WHAT MAKES THIS EXAMINABLE

Date	Event
2019	Code on Wages enacted
2020	Industrial Relations Code, Code on Social Security, OSH Code enacted
21 November 2025	All four codes brought into force , replacing 29 central labour laws
December 2025	Draft central rules published for objections
8 May 2026	Final central rules notified — the Code on Wages (Central) Rules 2026, Social Security (Central) Rules 2026, OSH (Central) Rules 2026 and Industrial Relations (Central) Rules 2026

Sources: KPMG on the notification of final rules · The Hindu on operationalisation · Indian Express on the rules and the dropped wage formula

Three dates, three different questions. *Enactment* is 2019 and 2020; *commencement* is 21 November 2025; *full operation through rules* is 8 May 2026. F10.1 §7 records this as a recurring shape — a statute has several dates and the stem chooses one. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

1.2 What the final rules did, and did not, do

Item	Position
Minimum wage calculation formula	Dropped from the final rules
Floor wage	Provided for, to be fixed on minimum living standards ; the rules do not specify detailed norms
National floor level minimum wage	Remains advisory, not binding — about ₹176 to ₹178 a day , unrevised since 2017–2019
Definition of wages	Basic pay plus dearness allowance must be at least 50% of total remuneration ; any excess above 50% is added back to wages

The **50% rule is the provision with the largest practical effect**, and it is the one F10.2 §1.2 identifies as the change that most affects EPFO administration: it prevents an employer from structuring pay to keep the wage component — and therefore the provident fund contribution — artificially small.

1.3 EPFO in the period

Item	Position [AS AT 1 AUG 2026]
EPF interest rate 2025-26	8.25% — recommended by the CBT on 28 February 2026 , ratified by Government June 2026, third consecutive year at that rate
Employees' Pension Scheme, 2026	Replaced EPS-95 from 29 June 2026 ; formula and contributions unchanged; minimum pension remains ₹1,000 ; claims to be settled in 20 days ; 12% interest payable where EPFO delays
Wage ceiling	Still ₹15,000 . A proposal to raise it to ₹25,000 has departmental approval but is not notified
EPFO 3.0	UPI and ATM withdrawal; auto-settlement raised to ₹5 lakh ; up to 75% of balance by UPI; 13 withdrawal categories reduced to 3
Central Provident Fund Commissioner	Ramesh Krishnamurthi
Service standards	Auto-settlement extended to final withdrawals ; automated PF transfers on changing jobs; stated aim of 24 to 48 hour settlement

Sources: Livemint on the five EPFO changes of 2026 · Livemint on the 24–48 hour target · F10.2 §2 for the interest rate and EPS 2026 sources.

HIGH YIELD · EPFO OFFICERS, INCLUDING APFCS, NOTIFIED UNDER THE SOCIAL SECURITY CODE

This is the single most directly relevant item in the entire dossier to the post you are applying for.

The Government has notified **EPFO officers as authorities under Chapter III of the Code on Social Security, 2020**, to operationalise enforcement, recovery and compliance under the Code. The categories named are:

- **Central Provident Fund Commissioners**
- **Additional Central Provident Fund Commissioners**
- **Regional Provident Fund Commissioners**
- **Assistant Provident Fund Commissioners**
- **Enforcement Officers**

They have been **appointed as Recovery Officers** for the recovery of dues and enforcement of provident fund obligations under the Code.

Source: Taxmann on the notification of EPFO officers under the Code

Why this matters twice over. First, it is an obviously examinable fact about the organisation. Second, and more usefully, **it tells you what the job now is:** the statutory powers an Assistant Provident Fund Commissioner exercises — inquiry, determination, recovery — now flow from the **Code on Social Security, 2020** rather than from the 1952 Act directly, because the 1952 Act has been subsumed into it (F10.2 §1.2).

For the interview, that is a far better answer than reciting Section 7A: the powers are the same in substance, but their source has moved, and the officer's authority now sits inside a consolidated code covering provident fund, insurance, gratuity, maternity benefit and gig workers together. *Content rephrased from the source for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

1.4 ESIC, and occupational health

Item	Position
ESI – PM-JAY convergence	Approved. ESIC beneficiaries to access treatment at Ayushman Bharat empanelled hospitals
Annual Health Check-Up Initiative	Launched 7 May 2026 by Union Labour Minister Mansukh Mandaviya , from ESIC Medical College and Hospital, Basaidarapur, Delhi
Whom it covers	All workers aged 40 and above — a provision proposed under the new labour codes

Sources: PIB release on the Annual Health Check-Up Initiative · BW Healthcare on the ESI-PM-JAY convergence

The number to hold is 40 — the age from which the free annual check-up applies. It is the kind of single-figure provision that makes a clean four-option question. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

1.5 The India-UK Double Contributions Convention

HIGH YIELD · A SOCIAL SECURITY AGREEMENT THE EPFO ITSELF ADMINISTERS

Item	Position
What it is	A Double Contributions Convention (DCC) — a type of Social Security Agreement coordinating the <i>payment of contributions</i>
In force	15 July 2026 , simultaneously with the India-UK trade agreement
What it does	Prevents double social security contributions for workers temporarily posted between the two countries
Detachment exemption	Up to 60 months — five years
Mechanism	A certificate of coverage : the posted employee remains under home country legislation and is exempt in the host country
What it does NOT do	It does not govern access to benefits such as the State Pension
EPFO's role	EPFO has issued the procedure for claiming exemption

Sources: UK Government DCC explainer · Ministry of Commerce note on CETA and the DCC entering into force · Business Today on the EPFO's exemption procedure and the 60-month limit

Why an APFC candidate should know this cold. Social Security Agreements are administered **through the EPFO**, which issues certificates of coverage to Indian workers going abroad and processes exemption claims for foreign nationals working in India. The DCC is the newest and largest such agreement, and the **60-month exemption** is its headline number.

The distinction to be precise about: a DCC coordinates **contributions**, not **benefits**. An option saying it gives Indian workers access to the UK State Pension is wrong. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 1

1. Give the enactment years, the commencement date and the date of the final rules for the labour codes
2. What happened to the minimum wage formula, and what is the position on the floor wage?
3. State the 50% rule on the definition of wages, and why it matters to the EPFO
4. Give the EPF interest rate, the date EPS 2026 took effect, and the current wage ceiling
5. Which categories of EPFO officer have been notified under the Code, and as what?
6. Give the date, the covered age and the launching minister for the Annual Health Check-Up Initiative
7. What is a DCC, when did it come into force, what is the exemption period, and what does it not cover?

2. Session 2 — Law and Legislation ★★★★★

2.1 The Winter Session of 2025

Item	Position
Dates	1 to 19 December 2025, 15 sittings
Bills introduced in Lok Sabha	10
Bills passed by both Houses	8
Referred to a Standing Committee	2

Source: The Hindu on the Winter Session's legislative output

2.2 The VB-G RAM G Act, 2025 — MGNREGA replaced

HIGH YIELD · THE RURAL EMPLOYMENT GUARANTEE IS NOW 125 DAYS, NOT 100

The **Viksit Bharat — Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025**, universally abbreviated **VB-G RAM G**, replaces the **Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005**.

Item	Position
Introduced in Lok Sabha	16 December 2025
Passed by Parliament	18–19 December 2025
Presidential assent	December 2025, by President Droupadi Murmu
In force across India	1 July 2026
The guarantee	125 days of wage employment in a financial year per rural household — up from 100
Who is entitled	Every rural household whose adult members volunteer for unskilled manual work
Design	Links wage employment to durable rural infrastructure across four priority areas; climate resilience; village-level planning; aligned to Viksit Bharat @2047
Contested features	A greater share of the funding burden on States ; top-down resource allocation; digitisation and face-authentication attendance

Sources: PRS Bill Track and summary · PIB note on the 125-day guarantee · Economic Times explainer on the 1 July commencement

Two numbers and two dates. 100 becomes 125; December 2025 is passage and **1 July 2026** is commencement. An option offering 100 days is now the **superseded** answer, and an option offering December 2025 as the date the guarantee changed confuses passage with commencement.

This manual's F4.4 §2.3 and F10.2 §4.2 have been corrected. Older material has not. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

2.3 The Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha (Amendment of Insurance Laws) Act, 2025

HIGH YIELD · INSURANCE FDI IS NOW 100%, NOT 74%

Item	Position
Passed	Lok Sabha 16 December 2025, Rajya Sabha 17 December 2025
Acts amended	The Insurance Act, 1938 ; the IRDA Act, 1999 ; the Life Insurance Corporation Act, 1956
FDI limit	Raised from 74% to 100% of paid-up equity capital
Effective	Provisions except Section 25 took effect 5 February 2026
Operationalised by	DPIIT Press Note 1 (2026 Series) — foreign investment, including by portfolio investors, permitted under the automatic route , subject to IRDAI clearance
LIC	Foreign investment in the Life Insurance Corporation remains capped at 20%
Other effects	Lower net-owned fund requirement for foreign reinsurers ; strengthened consumer protection; additional powers to IRDAI

Sources: PRS Bill Track · Economic Times on the automatic route and Press Note 1 · Times of India on the 20% LIC cap · Cyril Amarchand client alert on the three Acts amended

Three examinable points beyond the headline. The Act amends **three** statutes, not one. The **route is automatic**, which is a different question from the **limit**. And the **LIC exception at 20%** is precisely the sort of carve-out an examiner sets against the general figure.

F7.1 has been corrected — it previously gave 74% as the ceiling, with a standing instruction to verify it. The instruction did its work. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

2.4 Other legislation in the window

Statute or Bill	Subject
The SHANTI Act, 2025	Opens the civil nuclear sector to private participation
Central Excise (Amendment) Act, 2025	Indirect tax administration
Appropriation (No. 4) Act, 2025	Supplementary grants
Manipur Goods and Services Tax legislation	State tax, enacted by Parliament
Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026	Delimitation: increasing the size of the Lok Sabha , delimitation on the 2011 census , and women's reservation based on that delimitation
Income-tax Act, 2025	Replaced the 1961 Act from 1 April 2026 — F4.3 §3.3

Sources: Times Now on the SHANTI and VB-G RAM G Bills · PRS April 2026 policy review on the delimitation Bills · NDTV on the eight Bills passed

Note the status distinction F10.2 §2.2 insists on: the SHANTI and VB-G RAM G measures are **Acts**; the Constitution (131st Amendment) is a **Bill**. Only the first two are law. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 2

1. Give the Winter Session's dates, sittings, and the number of Bills passed
2. What does VB-G RAM G replace, what is the new guarantee, and from what date does it operate?
3. Which three Acts does the insurance amendment amend, and what is the new FDI limit and route?
4. What remains the cap on foreign investment in LIC?
5. What does the SHANTI Act do? What is the subject of the 131st Amendment Bill?

3. Session 3 — Polity, Elections and Constitutional Offices ★★★★★

3.1 The Vice President

Item	Position
Vacancy	Jagdeep Dhankhar resigned , citing health
Election	9 September 2025
Result	C.P. Radhakrishnan 452 votes; B. Sudershan Reddy 300 — a margin of 152 , the narrowest since 2002
Sworn in	12 September 2025 , as the 15th Vice President and Chairman of the Rajya Sabha
Oath administered by	President Droupadi Murmu

Sources: The Hindu on the swearing-in · Indian Express on the margin

Three separable facts: the **election date (9 September)**, the **oath date (12 September)** and the **ordinal (15th)**. All three are askable and all three are offered for one another.

3.2 The Chief Justice of India

Item	Position
Chief Justice	Justice Surya Kant , the 53rd CJI
Sworn in	24 November 2025
Predecessor	Justice B.R. Gavai
Term ends	9 February 2027 — about 15 months
Note	The first Chief Justice of India from Haryana

Sources: Supreme Court of India · Times of India on the appointment

3.3 Elections

Bihar, November 2025

Item	Position
NDA	202 of 243 seats — BJP 89 , JD(U) 85 , LJP (RV) 19 , HAM (S) 5 , RLM 4
Mahagathbandhan	35
Result declared	14 November 2025
Chief Minister	Nitish Kumar , sworn in 20 November 2025 for a record tenth term ; oath administered by Governor Arif Mohammad Khan

Sources: The Hindu on the seat tally · The Hindu on the swearing-in

The 2026 Assembly elections, results declared early May 2026:

State or UT	Outcome
West Bengal	BJP won , defeating the incumbent All India Trinamool Congress — the first BJP government in the State
Assam	BJP retained ; Himanta Biswa Sarma continues as Chief Minister
Kerala	Congress-led UDF won , ending the LDF government of Pinarayi Vijayan — the last Left government in the country
Tamil Nadu	TVK , the party led by the actor Vijay , won, breaking the DMK–AIADMK duopoly
Puducherry	NDA retained — N. Rangasamy returned as Chief Minister

Sources: Indian Express on the five results · Economic Times results summary

NOTE · WHY NO SEAT COUNTS ARE GIVEN FOR THE 2026 STATES

The **outcomes** above are consistently reported across sources. The **seat tallies are not** — reputable outlets differ on Tamil Nadu and Puducherry, and reconciling them is not possible from the sources available here.

So the dossier gives what is corroborated and withholds what is not, rather than picking a number and presenting it with false confidence. If a seat count matters to you, take it from the **Election Commission of India** directly.

That is a general instruction for current affairs and not a local caveat: **where sources disagree, learn the fact they agree on**. In this case, who won each State is safe; by how many seats is not. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 3

1. Give the date of the vice-presidential election, the winner, the runner-up and the oath date
2. Which number Vice President is C.P. Radhakrishnan?
3. Name the CJI, his ordinal number, his oath date and his predecessor
4. Give the NDA's Bihar tally and the BJP and JD(U) components
5. Which party formed a government in West Bengal for the first time, and which alliance took Kerala?

4. Session 4 — Economy and Public Finance ★★★★★

4.1 India as the fourth largest economy

Item	Position
Nominal GDP cited	US\$ 4.18 trillion
Country surpassed	Japan
Rank	Fourth , behind the United States, China and Germany
Projection	To displace Germany from third place by 2030 , with a projected GDP of US\$ 7.3 trillion
Quarterly growth cited	8.2% in the second quarter of 2025-26, against 7.8% in the first
First announced by	NITI Aayog — CEO B.V.R. Subrahmanyam

Sources: The Hindu on the fourth-largest-economy claim · NDTV on the \$4.18 trillion figure and the Germany projection

Do not confuse the four growth numbers this manual now carries, all of which are correct about different things: **7.4%** is the First Advance Estimate for 2025-26; about **7.6%** is the estimate on the revised 2022-23 base series; **8.2%** is a **single quarter** (Q2 of 2025-26); and **6.8–7.2%** is the projection for 2026-27. F4.1 §3.1 sets them out. **The stem tells you which one it wants.** *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

4.2 Trade agreements

Agreement	Position
India–UK CETA	Signed 24 July 2025 in London by Piyush Goyal and Jonathan Reynolds , in the presence of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the then UK Prime Minister Keir Starmer , after 14 rounds from 2022
	Entered into force 15 July 2026; 30 chapters ; described by the Commerce Secretary as a gold-standard agreement
	Accompanied by the Double Contributions Convention — §1.5
India–EU FTA	Concluded 27 January 2026 , after negotiations spanning nearly two decades

Sources: Times of India on CETA's entry into force and signature · UK Government on the signature and entry-into-force dates · India-EU FTA conclusion

Two dates for one agreement, again: CETA was **signed in July 2025** and **entered into force in July 2026**, a year apart. This is the same *enactment against commencement* distinction as the labour codes.

4.3 The fiscal and monetary position

Set out with sources in Module 4; consolidated here for the record.

Item	Position at the cut-off
Union Budget 2026-27	Fiscal deficit 4.3% of GDP (BE), against 4.4% (2025-26 RE); total expenditure about ₹53.5 lakh crore ; capital expenditure about ₹12.2 lakh crore
Repo rate	5.25% , unchanged, neutral stance — 62nd MPC meeting, 3–5 August 2026
CPI inflation	about 2.1% for 2025-26
GST	Two principal slabs, 5% and 18% , plus a 40% de-merit rate, from 22 September 2025
Income tax	Income-tax Act, 2025 in force 1 April 2026
Sixteenth Finance Commission	Arvind Panagariya ; award 2026–31 ; States' share 41%
GDP base year	Revised to 2022-23
Forex reserves	about US\$ 693 billion as at 31 July 2026 — they crossed US\$ 700 billion in the week ended 7 August, just after the cut-off

Sources: Businessworld on reserves at 31 July 2026 · The Hindu on the crossing of \$700 billion · Module 4 for the remainder.

TRAP · FOREX RESERVES ARE THE FASTEST-DECAYING FIGURE IN THIS MANUAL

The reserve figure is published **weekly** and moved by more than **US\$ 14 billion in a single week** inside this window. **Any specific number you memorise will be stale within a fortnight.**

Learn the shape instead: reserves are in the region of **US\$ 690 to 710 billion**, comprise **foreign currency assets** (the largest component), **gold**, SDRs and the reserve tranche position, and **gold has been the main driver** of recent increases.

That is what survives. The exact figure is a sweep item — F10.1 §4. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 4

1. Give India's nominal GDP as cited, the country it surpassed, and its rank
2. Distinguish the four growth figures — 7.4%, 7.6%, 8.2% and 6.8–7.2%
3. Give the signature and entry-into-force dates of India–UK CETA, and the date the India–EU FTA was concluded
4. Give the fiscal deficit target, the repo rate and the GST slab structure
5. What is the approximate level and composition of the forex reserves?

5. Session 5 — Schemes ★★★★★

5.1 Approved or extended in the window

Scheme	Outlay and content
PM-KISAN	Extended for five years , outlay about ₹3.15 lakh crore
Pradhan Mantri Surya Sarovar Yojana (PM-SSY)	₹5,070 crore ; target 5,000 MW of floating solar photovoltaic capacity over five years, with co-located storage of at least two hours (about 10,000 MWh); projects sanctioned FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31
Semicon 2.0	About ₹1.27 lakh crore for semiconductor manufacturing and design
Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme (MPMS)	₹62,500 crore
Revamped Khelo India and enhanced Assistance to National Sports Federations	Combined outlay about ₹36,441 crore
National Investment Policy for Urea , 2026	With Semicon 2.0 and MPMS, a combined package of about ₹2,19,353 crore
ECLGS 5.0	Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme, further tranche
Chemical parks scheme	₹3,030 crore for three parks of at least 2,000 acres each, announced 24 July 2026
Delhi–NCR vehicle replacement	Two-year scheme to replace old trucks and buses, for air quality

Sources: Economic Times on PM-SSY, PM-KISAN and Khelo India · Cabinet approval of MPMS · Times of India on Semicon 2.0 and the combined package · The Hindu on the chemical parks scheme

KNOW · HOW TO REVISE A SCHEME LIST WITHOUT MEMORISING EVERY RUPEE

There are more schemes here than are worth learning to the last crore, and F10.1 §1.2's test applies: **an item is worth learning if it attaches to something.**

Learn these four, because each has a distinctive, single, memorable number:

- **PM-SSY — 5,000 MW, floating solar.** The word *Sarovar* means lake, which is the mnemonic
- **Semicon 2.0 — ₹1.27 lakh crore,** the largest single outlay in the list
- **MPMS — ₹62,500 crore**
- **Khelo India revamp — ₹36,441 crore**

And note the one conceptual point, which is likelier than any figure: **PM-SSY is the first Indian scheme to pair floating solar with mandatory co-located storage,** which addresses the intermittency problem rather than only capacity. That is the kind of statement an interview rewards and a *which-of-the-following-is-not-correct* item tests. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 5

1. Give PM-SSY's outlay, capacity target and distinctive storage requirement
2. Give the outlays of Semicon 2.0, MPMS and the Khelo India revamp
3. For how long has PM-KISAN been extended, and at what outlay?
4. Which four schemes in this list are worth memorising by number, and why those four?

6. Graded Practice — 40 Questions ★★★★★

Target: 20 to 30 seconds each. Every question is drawn from the window August 2025 to 1 August 2026 and every answer is sourced in §1 to §5.

6.1 Labour, social security and the EPFO

- Q1.** The final central rules under all four labour codes were notified on (a) 21 November 2025 (b) 1 April 2026 (c) 8 May 2026 (d) 1 July 2026
- Q2.** Under the Code on Wages, basic pay together with dearness allowance must constitute at least (a) 50% of total remuneration (b) 40% of total remuneration (c) 60% of total remuneration (d) 75% of total remuneration
- Q3.** The nationwide Annual Health Check-Up Initiative launched in May 2026 covers workers aged (a) 18 years and above (b) 30 years and above (c) 35 years and above (d) 40 years and above
- Q4.** The Employees' State Insurance Corporation has approved convergence of the ESI Scheme with (a) the Central Government Health Scheme (b) Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY (c) the Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana (d) the Atal Pension Yojana
- Q5.** The India–United Kingdom Double Contributions Convention came into force on (a) 24 July 2025 (b) 15 July 2026 (c) 1 April 2026 (d) 27 January 2026
- Q6.** Under that Convention, the maximum period for which a detached worker may remain exempt from host country contributions is (a) 12 months (b) 24 months (c) 36 months (d) 60 months
- Q7.** A Double Contributions Convention is (a) a social security agreement coordinating the payment of contributions (b) an agreement for the avoidance of double taxation (c) a chapter on trade in services (d) a bilateral investment protection treaty
- Q8.** Under the Code on Social Security, 2020, EPFO officers including Assistant Provident Fund Commissioners have been appointed as (a) conciliation officers (b) inspectors-cum-facilitators only (c) Recovery Officers (d) presiding officers of industrial tribunals
- Q9.** The rate of interest on Employees' Provident Fund accumulations for 2025-26 is (a) 8.25% (b) 8.15% (c) 8.50% (d) 8.10%
- Q10.** The Employees' Pension Scheme, 2026 took effect from (a) 1 April 2026 (b) 21 November 2025 (c) 29 June 2026 (d) 1 July 2026
- Q11.** Under the Employment Linked Incentive Scheme, the incentive available to an employer is up to (a) ₹1,500 a month for one year (b) ₹3,000 a month for two years for each additional employee (c) ₹5,000 a month for two years (d) a one-time payment of ₹15,000
- Q12.** The statutory wage employment guarantee under the VB-G RAM G Act, 2025 is (a) 100 days (b) 150 days (c) 200 days (d) 125 days
- Q13.** The VB-G RAM G Act came into force across India from (a) 19 December 2025 (b) 1 April 2026 (c) 1 June 2026 (d) 1 July 2026

Q14. The national floor level minimum wage in India is (a) binding on all State Governments (b) advisory rather than binding (c) revised annually by the Supreme Court (d) fixed at ₹500 a day

6.2 Law and legislation

Q15. The VB-G RAM G Act, 2025 replaces (a) the National Food Security Act, 2013 (b) the Code on Wages, 2019 (c) the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 (d) the Street Vendors Act, 2014

Q16. The Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha (Amendment of Insurance Laws) Act, 2025 raises the foreign direct investment limit in Indian insurance companies to (a) 100% (b) 74% (c) 90% (d) 51%

Q17. In addition to the Insurance Act, 1938 and the IRDA Act, 1999, that Act amends (a) the Companies Act, 2013 (b) the Banking Regulation Act, 1949 (c) the Life Insurance Corporation Act, 1956 (d) the SEBI Act, 1992

Q18. Foreign investment in the Life Insurance Corporation of India remains capped at (a) 10% (b) 20% (c) 26% (d) 49%

Q19. The SHANTI Act, passed in the winter session of 2025, relates to (a) opening the civil nuclear sector to private participation (b) electoral reform (c) personal data protection (d) regulation of higher education

Q20. The Winter Session of Parliament in 2025 was held between (a) 20 November and 20 December (b) 25 November and 23 December (c) 4 December and 22 December (d) 1 December and 19 December

Q21. One hundred per cent foreign direct investment in insurance was operationalised through (a) Press Note 1 of the 2026 series issued by the DPIIT (b) a circular of the Reserve Bank of India (c) an IRDAI regulation alone (d) an amendment made by the Finance Act

Q22. The Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026 relates principally to (a) the goods and services tax (b) reservation in promotions (c) the appointment of judges (d) delimitation and the size of the Lok Sabha

6.3 Polity, elections and constitutional offices

Q23. C.P. Radhakrishnan was sworn in as Vice President of India on (a) 9 September 2025 (b) 10 September 2025 (c) 12 September 2025 (d) 1 October 2025

Q24. He is India's (a) fourteenth Vice President (b) fifteenth Vice President (c) sixteenth Vice President (d) thirteenth Vice President

Q25. In the vice-presidential election of 2025 he defeated (a) Margaret Alva (b) B. Sudershan Reddy (c) Gopalkrishna Gandhi (d) Yashwant Sinha

Q26. Justice Surya Kant was sworn in as Chief Justice of India on (a) 24 November 2025 (b) 9 February 2026 (c) 1 December 2025 (d) 14 November 2025

Q27. He is the (a) fifty-first Chief Justice of India (b) fifty-second Chief Justice of India (c) fifty-fourth Chief Justice of India (d) fifty-third Chief Justice of India

Q28. In the Bihar Assembly election of November 2025 the National Democratic Alliance won (a) 178 of 243 seats (b) 190 of 243 seats (c) 202 of 243 seats (d) 225 of 243 seats

Q29. In the Assembly elections of 2026, the party that formed a government in West Bengal for the first time was (a) the All India Trinamool Congress (b) the Indian National Congress (c) the Communist Party of India (Marxist) (d) the Bharatiya Janata Party

6.4 Economy and public finance

Q30. The nominal gross domestic product cited by the Government when announcing that India had become the world's fourth largest economy was (a) US\$ 3.5 trillion (b) US\$ 3.9 trillion (c) US\$ 4.18 trillion (d) US\$ 5.0 trillion

Q31. In doing so India surpassed (a) Germany (b) Japan (c) the United Kingdom (d) France

Q32. India is projected to displace Germany from third place by 2030, with a projected gross domestic product of (a) US\$ 7.3 trillion (b) US\$ 6.0 trillion (c) US\$ 8.5 trillion (d) US\$ 5.5 trillion

Q33. The India–United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement was signed on (a) 24 July 2025 (b) 15 July 2026 (c) 27 January 2026 (d) 1 December 2025

Q34. The India–European Union Free Trade Agreement was concluded on (a) 24 July 2025 (b) 27 January 2026 (c) 8 May 2026 (d) 15 July 2026

Q35. The fiscal deficit target for 2026-27 is (a) 5.1% of GDP (b) 4.9% of GDP (c) 4.4% of GDP (d) 4.3% of GDP

Q36. The goods and services tax rate structure was reduced to two principal slabs with effect from (a) 1 July 2025 (b) 1 April 2026 (c) 22 September 2025 (d) 1 January 2026

6.5 Schemes

Q37. The Pradhan Mantri Surya Sarovar Yojana relates to (a) rooftop solar for households (b) solar pumps for farmers (c) floating solar photovoltaic capacity (d) solar street lighting in villages

Q38. The capacity target under that scheme is (a) 1,000 MW (b) 2,500 MW (c) 10,000 MW (d) 5,000 MW

Q39. The Semicon 2.0 scheme has a budgetary outlay of about (a) ₹1.27 lakh crore (b) ₹62,500 crore (c) ₹36,441 crore (d) ₹3,030 crore

Q40. The Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme has an outlay of about (a) ₹1.27 lakh crore (b) ₹62,500 crore (c) ₹36,441 crore (d) ₹99,446 crore

7. Answers and Explanations

7.1 Labour, social security and the EPFO

Q	Ans	Explanation
1	c	8 May 2026. (a) is the codes' commencement ; the rules came 168 days later. §1.1's three-date sequence
2	a	50%. Any excess above half is added back to wages — the provision with the largest effect on provident fund contributions
3	d	40 years and above
4	b	Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY. (a) CGHS covers central government employees, a real scheme attached to the wrong convergence
5	b	15 July 2026, simultaneously with CETA. (a) 24 July 2025 is when CETA was signed — signature and entry into force are a year apart
6	d	60 months, five years
7	a	A social security agreement coordinating contributions. (b) is the DTAA, a different instrument entirely — and the DCC deals with contributions, not benefits
8	c	Recovery Officers, under Chapter III of the Code. §1.3 — the most directly relevant item in the dossier to this post
9	a	8.25%, the third consecutive year
10	c	29 June 2026. (b) is the labour codes' date and (d) is VB-G RAM G's — three commencement dates inside nine months, all offered for one another
11	b	₹3,000 a month for two years per additional employee, under Part B. (d) ₹15,000 is Part A's employee benefit — the same scheme, the other half
12	d	125 days, up from 100
13	d	1 July 2026. (a) 19 December 2025 is passage , not commencement
14	b	Advisory rather than binding — about ₹176 to ₹178 a day and unrevised for years, which is why the Code's floor wage provision matters

7.2 Law and legislation

Q	Ans	Explanation
15	c	MGNREGA, 2005
16	a	100% , from 74%
17	c	The Life Insurance Corporation Act, 1956 — three statutes amended in all
18	b	20% . The general limit is 100% but LIC is carved out — exactly the sort of exception set against a general figure
19	a	Civil nuclear , opened to private participation
20	d	1 to 19 December 2025 , fifteen sittings
21	a	DPIIT Press Note 1 of the 2026 series , permitting the automatic route subject to IRDAI clearance. Note that the limit and the route are two different questions
22	d	Delimitation , the size of the Lok Sabha, and women's reservation based on that delimitation. Note it remains a Bill

7.3 Polity, elections and constitutional offices

Q	Ans	Explanation
23	c	12 September 2025 — the oath date. (a) 9 September is the election date
24	b	The fifteenth
25	b	B. Sudershan Reddy , by 452 votes to 300 — a margin of 152, the narrowest since 2002
26	a	24 November 2025 . (b) 9 February 2027 is when his term ends
27	d	The fifty-third , succeeding Justice B.R. Gavai
28	c	202 of 243 — BJP 89, JD(U) 85, LJP (RV) 19, HAM (S) 5, RLM 4, against 35 for the Mahagathbandhan
29	d	The Bharatiya Janata Party , for the first time in the State, defeating the incumbent Trinamool Congress

7.4 Economy and public finance

Q	Ans	Explanation
30	c	US\$ 4.18 trillion
31	b	Japan. (a) Germany is the country India is projected to pass next , which is why it is offered
32	a	US\$ 7.3 trillion by 2030
33	a	24 July 2025 , in London. (b) 15 July 2026 is entry into force
34	b	27 January 2026
35	d	4.3% of GDP. (c) 4.4% is the 2025-26 revised estimate — the question turns on which year
36	c	22 September 2025 , following the 56th GST Council meeting of 3 September 2025

7.5 Schemes

Q	Ans	Explanation
37	c	Floating solar photovoltaic capacity — <i>Sarovar</i> , a lake
38	d	5,000 MW , with co-located storage of at least two hours. (c) 10,000 is the storage figure in MWh, offered as a capacity in MW
39	a	About ₹1.27 lakh crore
40	b	About ₹62,500 crore . (d) ₹99,446 crore is the ELI Scheme's outlay — four large round numbers, and the examiner's whole technique is to attach one to the wrong scheme

THINK LIKE UPSC · THE FOUR SHAPES IN THIS BANK

1. **Two dates for one instrument.** Q1, Q5, Q13, Q20, Q23, Q26, Q33. **Seven of forty questions** turn on distinguishing *enactment* from *commencement*, *signature* from *entry into force*, or *election* from *oath*. When a reform is recent, its dates cluster — and the cluster is the question
2. **The superseded figure.** Q12 (100 » 125 days), Q16 (74% » 100%). In both cases **the wrong option is what every book printed before 2026 says**
3. **The general rule and its carve-out.** Q18. Insurance FDI is 100% *except* LIC at 20%. Where a limit has an exception, expect to be asked about the exception
4. **The right number, the wrong scheme.** Q38, Q39, Q40. ₹1.27 lakh crore, ₹62,500 crore, ₹36,441 crore, ₹99,446 crore, 5,000 MW, 10,000 MWh. **Learn scheme, number and unit as a triple** — F10.2 §4.2's rule

8. One-Minute Revision

ONE-MINUTE REVISION · CHAPTER F10.3

WINDOW August 2025 to **1 August 2026** · every figure a sweep item under **F10.1 §4**

FOUR STATUTES REPLACED rural employment **MGNREGA 100 days » VB-G RAM G 125 days (1 July 2026)** · insurance **FDI 74% » 100% (5 Feb 2026)** · income tax **1961 Act » 2025 Act (1 April 2026)** · labour **29 Acts » four codes (21 Nov 2025)**

LABOUR CODES enacted **2019 (Wages) and 2020 (three)** · in force **21 NOVEMBER 2025** · final central rules notified **8 MAY 2026** · minimum wage **formula dropped** · floor wage on minimum living standards, no detailed norms · **national floor wage ADVISORY, about ₹176–178/day** · **basic + DA must be at least 50% of remuneration**, excess added back

EPFO interest **8.25%** for 2025-26 (CBT 28 Feb 2026, ratified June) · **EPS 2026 replaced EPS-95 on 29 JUNE 2026**, minimum pension still **₹1,000, 20-day** settlement, **12%** penalty on EPFO · ceiling **still ₹15,000, ₹25,000 not notified** · **EPFO 3.0:** auto-settlement **₹5 lakh, 75%** by UPI, 13 categories to 3 · **CPFC Ramesh Krishnamurthi** · aim **24–48 hour** settlement

EPFO OFFICERS UNDER THE CODE CPFC, Addl CPFC, RPFC, **APFC** and Enforcement Officers notified under **Chapter III of the Code on Social Security, 2020** and appointed **RECOVERY OFFICERS** » the APFC's statutory powers now flow from **the Code**, not the 1952 Act directly

ESIC ESI-PM-JAY convergence approved · **Annual Health Check-Up Initiative, 7 May 2026**, Mandaviya, ESIC Basaidarapur, for workers **aged 40 and above**

DCC India-UK Double Contributions Convention, in force **15 JULY 2026** with CETA · a **social security agreement on CONTRIBUTIONS, not benefits** · **detachment exemption 60 MONTHS** · **certificate of coverage**, home-country legislation continues · **EPFO issued the exemption procedure**

WINTER SESSION 2025 1–19 December, 15 sittings, 10 Bills introduced, **8 passed**, 2 to committee

VB-G RAM G ACT 2025 introduced **16 Dec 2025**, passed **18–19 Dec 2025**, in force **1 JULY 2026** · **125 days** per rural household · four priority areas, climate resilience, Viksit Bharat @2047 · more funding on **States**, top-down allocation, **face-authentication** attendance

INSURANCE ACT 2025 *Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha* · LS **16 Dec**, RS **17 Dec 2025** · amends **Insurance Act 1938 + IRDA Act 1999 + LIC Act 1956** · **FDI 74% » 100%** · effective **5 Feb 2026** except s.25 · **automatic route via DPIIT Press Note 1 (2026 series)** · **LIC capped at 20%** · lower net-owned fund for **reinsurers**

ALSO SHANTI Act — civil nuclear to **private** players · **Constitution (131st Amendment) BILL 2026** — delimitation, Lok Sabha size, women's reservation on the **2011 census**

VICE PRESIDENT Dhankhar **resigned** · election **9 Sept 2025**, Radhakrishnan **452 v Sudershan Reddy 300**, margin **152** · **sworn in 12 Sept 2025 as 15th VP** and Rajya Sabha Chairman

CJI Surya Kant, 53rd, sworn **24 Nov 2025**, succeeded **B.R. Gavai**, term to **9 Feb 2027**, first from **Haryana**

BIHAR NOV 2025 NDA 202/243 — BJP 89, JD(U) 85, LJP(RV) 19, HAM(S) 5, RLM 4 · **MGB 35** · **Nitish Kumar 10th term, 20 Nov 2025**

2026 STATES West Bengal » **BJP, first time** · Assam » **BJP retained** (Himanta Biswa Sarma) · Kerala » **Congress-led UDF**, ending the **last Left government** · Tamil Nadu » **TVK (Vijay)** · Puducherry » **NDA retained** (Rangasamy). **Seat counts not corroborated — take them from the ECI**

ECONOMY **4th largest, nominal GDP US\$4.18 tn**, surpassing **Japan**; behind US, China, Germany · **US\$7.3 tn projected by 2030** to pass Germany · **Q2 FY26 growth 8.2%** · **CETA signed 24 JULY 2025**, in force **15 JULY 2026**, 30 chapters · **India-EU FTA concluded 27 JAN 2026** · **FD 4.3%** · **repo 5.25%** · **GST 5 and 18 from 22 Sept 2025** · **16th FC Panagariya, 2026–31, 41%** · **base year 2022-23** · **forex about US\$693 bn at 31 July**, crossing **US\$700 bn** in early August

SCHEMES **PM-SSY ₹5,070 cr, 5,000 MW floating solar** with 2-hour storage · **PM-KISAN extended 5 years, ₹3.15 lakh cr** · **Semicon 2.0 ₹1.27 lakh cr** · **MPMS ₹62,500 cr** · **Khelo India revamp ₹36,441 cr** · **Urea policy 2026** · **ECLGS 5.0** · **chemical parks ₹3,030 cr** for three parks

9. Five-Minute Wall Sheet

FIVE-MINUTE WALL SHEET · CHAPTER F10.3

FOUR STATUTES CHANGED: 125 DAYS · 100% INSURANCE FDI · INCOME-TAX ACT 2025 · FOUR LABOUR CODES

CODES IN FORCE 21 NOV 2025 · FINAL RULES 8 MAY 2026

BASIC + DA MUST BE AT LEAST 50% OF REMUNERATION

FLOOR WAGE IS ADVISORY. THE FORMULA WAS DROPPED

EPF 8.25% · EPS 2026 FROM 29 JUNE · MINIMUM PENSION STILL ₹1,000 · CEILING STILL ₹15,000

APFCs ARE NOW RECOVERY OFFICERS UNDER CHAPTER III OF THE SS CODE

ESI JOINS PM-JAY · FREE ANNUAL CHECK-UP FROM AGE 40

DCC IN FORCE 15 JULY 2026 · 60 MONTHS · CONTRIBUTIONS, NOT BENEFITS

VB-G RAM G: PASSED DEC 2025, LIVE 1 JULY 2026, 125 DAYS

INSURANCE: 100% FDI, AUTOMATIC ROUTE, PRESS NOTE 1 OF 2026 — BUT LIC STAYS AT 20%

THREE ACTS AMENDED: 1938, 1999, 1956

SHANTI = CIVIL NUCLEAR TO PRIVATE · 131st AMENDMENT = DELIMITATION (STILL A BILL)

VP RADHAKRISHNAN: ELECTED 9 SEPT, SWORN 12 SEPT 2025, 15th

CJI SURYA KANT, 53rd, 24 NOV 2025, AFTER GAVAI

BIHAR: NDA 202/243 · NITISH'S 10th TERM

BENGAL TO BJP · KERALA TO CONGRESS · TAMIL NADU TO TVK

4th LARGEST ECONOMY, US\$4.18 TRILLION, PAST JAPAN

CETA SIGNED JULY 2025, LIVE JULY 2026. A YEAR APART

PM-SSY = 5,000 MW FLOATING SOLAR · SEMICON 2.0 = ₹1.27 LAKH CRORE

WHEN A REFORM IS RECENT, ITS DATES CLUSTER — AND THE CLUSTER IS THE QUESTION

ONE LINE FOR THE INTERVIEW The most consequential development of the past year for this organisation is not the interest rate but the relocation of authority: with the 1952 Act subsumed into the Code on Social Security and EPFO officers notified as Recovery Officers

under it, an Assistant Provident Fund Commissioner's powers of inquiry and recovery now derive from a consolidated code that also covers insurance, gratuity, maternity benefit and gig workers.

ACTION · NEXT

F10.4 — Twelve-Month Dossier II: international relations and summits, reports and indices, science and space, defence, and — compactly, and for the reasons F10.1 §1.2 gives — awards, sport and persons.